

Impact Medium · Difficulty Hard · Misuse risk It fails when the pause becomes stalling — using a calm, slow delivery to dodge

THE MOVE

Cue -> one beat -> drop the pace -> simplest true sentence -> pause -> follow or release. -> "Let me slow that down. The main point is?" -> "I need a beat before I answer." (then answer, slowly) -> "One thing at a time — here's the simple ?

START HERE

Pause for one beat, drop your pace by a notch, and answer with the simplest true sentence.

SAY THIS

Quick	<i>"Let me slow that down."</i>
Warm	<i>"I want to answer that carefully."</i>
Professional	<i>"The main point is?"</i>
Direct	<i>"Here's the short answer."</i>
Repair	<i>"Let me say that more simply."</i>
High-stakes	<i>"I hear the urgency. Give me one beat."</i>

AVOID

- When physical safety or an emergency needs immediate action, not a pause
- When you would be using the slowdown to dodge accountability or run out the clock
- When the answer is already clear and direct, and slowing it down just adds drag

REMEMBER

Shorten the first sentence, not the whole answer.